

Unilever Presentation

Pasta & Noodles Category Review

South Africa | 12 months to June 2026

Updated: 18/08/2026



AGENDA -

Key business questions from the brief

Primary analysis: 12 months Jul 25–Jun 26 · latest month Jun 26

01 — Category growth

Where is the Pasta value / volume opportunity?

02 — Key players

Who plays in Pasta and Noodles, and who is winning or losing?

03 — Pack & price

What is the Noodles price architecture?

04 — Unilever position

Where do Knorr Pasta Pots sit versus competing SKUs?

05 — Commercial action

What should Unilever Protect, Watch and Test?

Pasta category - Key market insights

Pasta is a R3.3bn category growing +5.2% in value with volume slightly down. Noodles now contribute 64% of value and are the engine of growth.

Category growth

R3.3bn

12-month value +5.2% vs YA. Volume -0.7%. June 2026 R337.1m, +7.7% vs Jun 25. Growth is price/mix, not more tonnes.

Noodles concentration

64%

Noodles is 64.4% of Pasta value, up 1.8pp vs year ago. Macaroni 21% and spaghetti 13% are dry pasta. Unilever is only in Noodles.



Who is winning / losing

Kellogg's +2.1pp

Kellogg's 29% of Pasta (+2.1pp) and Indomie +1.4pp. Nestlé -2.7pp, Mr Pasta -2.0pp, Tiger -1.5pp. Tiger leads dry pasta; Kellogg's/Nestlé lead because Noodles is most of the value.

Price architecture

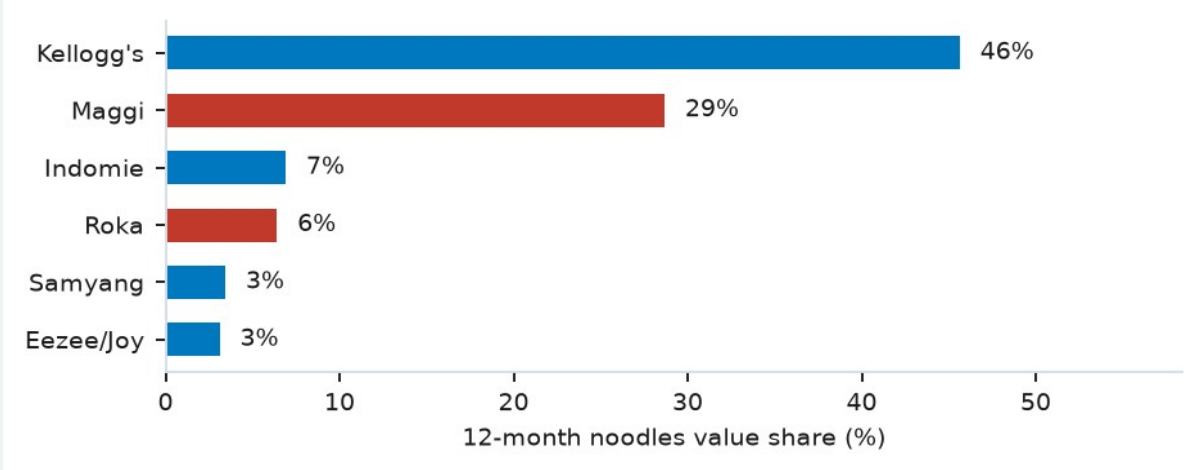
R58/kg

Category average R58/kg. Noodles R96/kg. Dry pasta (macaroni/spaghetti) ~R32-35/kg. Two different businesses sit inside one Pasta file.

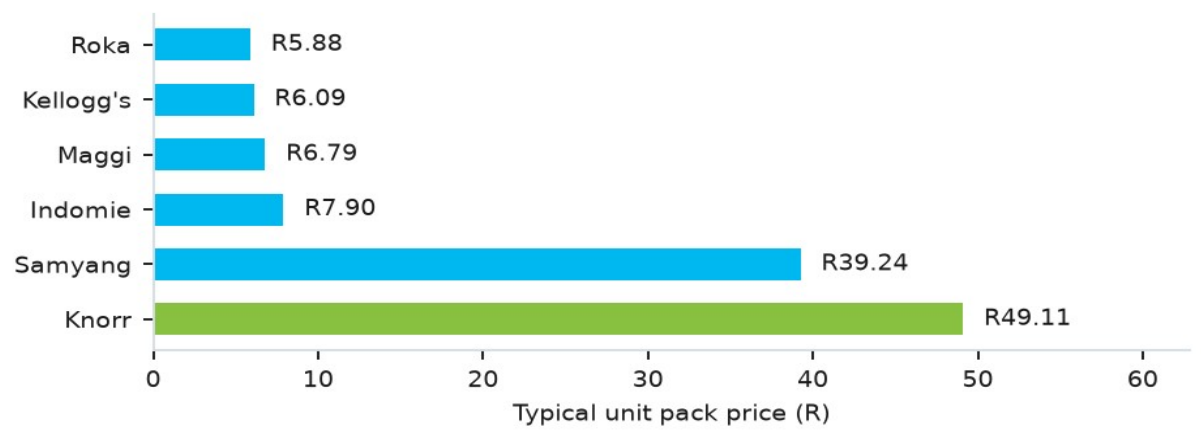
Noodles - Who plays, who is winning, what price point?

Kellogg's is taking share from Maggi. The mass market is a R5–8 sachet. Knorr Pasta Pots entered in June at ~R49 — a different occasion, not a sachet competitor.

12-month noodles value share



Price ladder — typical unit pack



Competitive scorecard

Brand	12m	Jun 26	vs YA	Value	R/kg
Kellogg's	45.6%	44.3%	+2.0pp	+13.1%	R87
Maggi	28.7%	28.2%	-5.1pp	-8.2%	R100
Indomie	6.9%	7.8%	+2.1pp	+55.7%	R99
Roka	6.4%	5.1%	-0.4pp	+1.5%	R69
Samyang	3.4%	3.3%	+1.8pp	+122.3%	R302
Eezee/Joy	3.1%	4.4%	+2.0pp	+217.1%	R356
Mr Pasta	1.9%	1.5%	-2.3pp	-50.7%	R147
Knorr	0.1%	0.6%	+0.1pp	n/a	R790

Unilever competing SKUs — June 2026 only

SKU	Value	Mix	R/pot	R/kg
Carbonara	R603k	49%	R49.05	R779/kg
Tomato & Mozzarella	R368k	30%	R49.22	R781/kg
Mushroom	R269k	22%	R49.08	R832/kg

Noodles - How Unilever should read this category

Knorr Pasta Pots are a R1.24m June entry (0.56% of Noodles). They do not compete in the R6 sachet game that is 86% of noodles value. Treat them as a cup/meal occasion and keep the three SKUs from fragmenting.

Protect the read

Why?

- Noodles is the Pasta category (64% of value, +8.2%).
- Kellogg's 46% and Maggi 29% set the competitive frame.
- Dry pasta is Tiger / private label at R32-35/kg — Unilever is absent.

Action

Do not brief Pasta Pots as a Maggi 2-minute sachet competitor.

Watch Maggi's loss

Why?

- Maggi -5.1pp over 12 months; Kellogg's +2.0pp.
- Indomie +2.1pp and Samyang +1.8pp are the other gainers.
- Mr Pasta -2.3pp — value/mid is under pressure.

Action

Use Maggi's share loss as the main competitive opening to watch, not to copy on price.

Price architecture

Why?

- Roka ~R5.88 · Kellogg's ~R6.09 · Maggi ~R6.79.
- Indomie ~R7.90. Samyang ~R39 (ramen/cup).
- Knorr Pasta Pots ~R49 / ~R790/kg — ~8× sachet.

Action

Hold ~R49. Promo into the R6 band would destroy the proposition.

Test the range

Why?

- Carbonara is 49% of the line; Mushroom is the smallest.
- Three SKUs at one price compete with each other first.
- June only — no 12-month Unilever trend yet.

Action

Keep distribution and visibility on Carbonara; measure incrementality vs cannibalisation across the three pots.



Thank You!

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